

## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

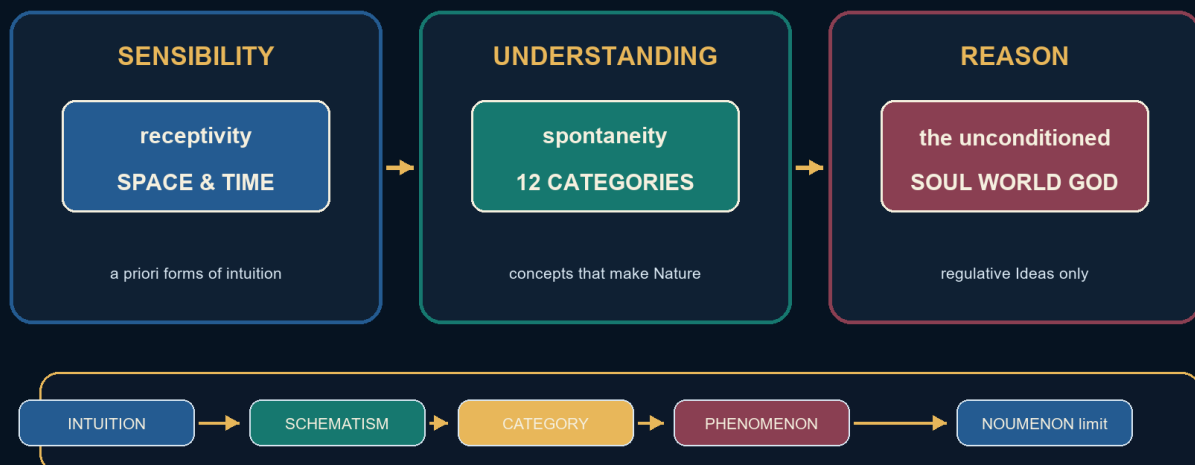
# KANT - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper I Western Philosophy 04

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

## PHILOSOPHY PAPER I | WESTERN PHILOSOPHY 04

### KANT

How is synthetic a priori knowledge possible? Objects conform to the mind.



Copernican Revolution | phenomena knowable, noumena only thinkable | valid ONLY within possible experience

*Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.*

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

# KANT - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper I Western Philosophy 04

## Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Western Philosophy Paper I bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 10 Kant-owned questions; none in 2025. Questions owned by Quine-Strawson (2018 Q2c), Empiricism (2020 Q2a, 2025 Q2c) and Hegel (2025 Q1e) are excluded despite mentioning Kant.
- The 2023 Q1(a) printed anomaly ('Precepts without concepts...') is preserved exactly; the accurate A51/B75 line is given in the solution.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: claim -> named text (A/B) -> analysis -> objection/reply -> verdict.
- MCQs: 28 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 36, strict A-B-C-D rotation nine times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Contemporary linkage: the Kant-Studien / de Boer analogical-reasoning anchor lives in the main session; it is scholarship, not doctrinal proof, and no bibliographic detail is invented.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

## Practice Design

The workbook sequence is exact verified PYQs -> 28 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED TEXT/EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION/REPLY -> VERDICT

## SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 10 VERIFIED KANT QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the continuous local Western Philosophy Paper I bank for 2018-2025. Kant owns exactly 10 primary parts and has no owned question in 2025. Questions that merely mention Kant but are owned by Quine-Strawson (2018 Q2c), Empiricism (2020 Q2a, 2025 Q2c) or Hegel (2025 Q1e) are deliberately excluded. The 2023 Q1(a) printed anomaly ('Precepts...') is preserved exactly as printed.

### Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q2(b), 15 marks

**Question:** Explain the significance of the Kantian dictum, 'Understanding makes Nature'. How far do you agree that Hegel's Absolutism is the culmination of the Kantian Dualism? Discuss. Give reasons in favour of your answer.

#### Model solution

**Thesis (directive: explain + agree with reasons).** "Understanding makes Nature" means the understanding *legislates the lawful, objective form* of experienced nature through its a priori categories; it does not manufacture things. Hegel's Absolutism is best read as a **radicalisation and attempted overcoming** of Kantian dualism, not a smooth culmination of it.

**Doctrine - the dictum.** For Kant, sensations alone are an unordered manifold. Only when the manifold is synthesised under categories such as **substance** and **causality**, unified by the transcendental unity of apperception (the "I think"), does it count as an objective, law-governed world. Hence nature - as the totality of appearances under universal laws - conforms to the conditions of possible experience. This is the Copernican Revolution applied: the understanding supplies the *form* of nature (its lawfulness), the senses supply the *matter*.

**Named distinction / qualification.** The dictum is transcendental, not empirical: private imagination does not create objects, and things-in-themselves are untouched. Transcendental idealism is simultaneously an **empirical realism** - appearances are publicly real even though known only under our forms.

**Hegel - culmination or overcoming?** Hegel accepts thought's constitutive activity but rejects the unknowable **noumenal remainder**: reason must comprehend the subject/object opposition as *moments within the Absolute*, so there is no wall between appearance and reality. That is not a deduction *from* Kantian dualism but a *dissolution* of it.

**Verdict.** "Understanding makes Nature" is Kant's compressed statement of transcendental constitution; Hegel's Absolutism completes the *impulse* to make thought constitutive while abolishing the very dualism (phenomena/noumena) that defines Kant - hence "culmination" is defensible only as radical transformation, not continuation.

### Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q4(a), 20 marks

**Question:** How does Kant argue for the transcendence of Space and Time? Discuss.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** By "transcendence" of space and time the paper means their **a priori, non-empirical character**. Kant argues for it in two stages - the metaphysical exposition (that they are a priori and intuitive) and the transcendental exposition (that they ground synthetic a priori science) - concluding that they are transcendently ideal yet empirically real.

**Metaphysical exposition (space; time by parallel).** (1) *Not from experience*: to perceive things as "outside" or "beside" me I must already represent space, so space is presupposed, not abstracted. (2) *Necessary*: I can represent space empty of objects but not objects without space. (3) *Singular intuition, not concept*: there is one space, of which particular spaces are limitations - a concept has instances *under* it, space has parts *within* it. (4) *Given as infinite*: an infinite whole is given, which no general concept can contain. The same holds for time as the form of inner sense.

**Transcendental exposition.** The a priori intuition of space explains how **geometry** is synthetic a priori (we construct figures in pure intuition, so results hold necessarily of all outer objects); the a priori intuition of time explains **arithmetic** and pure mechanics (succession, duration, simultaneity).

**Consequence.** Space and time are **transcendentally ideal** (not features of things-in-themselves) but **empirically real** (objectively valid for every appearance).

**Verdict / objection.** The transcendental argument from *Euclidean* geometry lapsed once geometry ceased to be uniquely Euclidean; but the metaphysical exposition (space as a given singular whole, not a concept) is independent of that and carries the a priori claim. Kant thereby defeats both Newton (absolute things) and Leibniz (relations of things) without collapsing into Berkeley.

### Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q3(c), 15 marks

**Question:** When does Pure Reason enter into the realm of Antinomies according to Kant? Is Kant's notion of Antinomies of Pure Reason a natural culmination of his distinction between Phenomena and Noumena? Give reasons in favour of your answer.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Pure reason enters the antinomies the moment it applies the categories - specifically the demand for the **unconditioned totality** - *beyond possible experience*, treating the world-series as a completed whole. Yes: the antinomies are a **natural culmination** of the phenomena/noumena distinction, because their resolution simply *is* that distinction applied.

**When reason enters.** Understanding legitimately applies categories to intuitions within experience. Reason (Vernunft), seeking the unconditioned ground of every conditioned thing, extends the categories to the **world as a whole** - an object never given in experience. At that overreach, equally valid-looking proofs generate contradictory thesis/antithesis pairs: the antinomies.

**The four, briefly.** (1) beginning/limit vs infinity; (2) simple parts vs no simple; (3) freedom vs universal natural causality; (4) a necessary being vs none. The first two are **mathematical**, the last two **dynamical**.

**Culmination of phenomena/noumena.** *Mathematical antinomies*: both thesis and antithesis are **false**, because the "world-whole" is not a legitimate object - the error is treating phenomena (an incomplete series) as a noumenal completed totality. *Dynamical antinomies*: both can be **true** in different domains - natural necessity holds for phenomena, freedom and a necessary being are possible for noumena. In every case the cure is the phenomena/noumena boundary.

**Verdict.** The antinomies are the **indirect proof** of transcendental idealism: realism about appearances breeds contradiction; the phenomena/noumena distinction dissolves it. So Kant's answer to the question is affirmative - the antinomies are where that distinction does its most dramatic work, though Hegel contests that contradiction must be

pathological rather than productive.

### Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 Q2(c), 15 marks

**Question:** Explain how Cartesian formulation of ontological argument is criticised by Kant.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Kant criticises the Cartesian (Anselmian) ontological argument by denying its hidden premise that existence is a perfection contained in the concept of God: "**existence is not a real predicate**".

**The Cartesian argument.** (1) God is the most perfect / most real being; (2) existence is a perfection; (3) a God lacking existence would lack a perfection and so would not be most perfect; (4) therefore God necessarily exists. Descartes treats necessary existence as *contained in* the very idea of a supremely perfect being, as three angles are contained in the idea of a triangle.

**Kant's refutation.** A **real predicate** (Bestimmung) enlarges or determines a concept. "Existence" does no such thing - it merely **posits** the object as actual. "A hundred real thalers do not contain the least coin more than a hundred possible thalers": the *concept* is identical whether or not the object exists. So one cannot pack existence into the concept of God and then extract God's actuality by analysis. To assert "God exists" is to posit the whole concept as instantiated, not to unfold a property inside it.

**Consequence.** No concept, however perfect, entails the existence of its object outside thought; the ontological inference confuses logical necessity *within* the concept with real existence.

**Verdict.** The classical Cartesian version is refuted decisively; defining a thing into existence is impossible. (Modern modal reformulations reopen the debate, but the Cartesian formulation the question names falls to "existence is not a real predicate.")

### Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 Q1(e), 10 marks

**Question:** What is apperception, according to Immanuel Kant? Discuss with reference to his transcendental exposition of space and time.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Apperception, for Kant, is the **transcendental unity of self-consciousness** - the formal condition that the "**I think**" must be able to accompany all my representations. It is presupposed by, and connected to, the transcendental exposition of space and time as the unity that synthesises what they supply.

**Doctrine.** Every representation that is to be *mine* must be capable of being united in one consciousness; otherwise something would be represented in me that could not be thought as mine. This unity is **not** an empirical, introspectable self (not Hume's bundle) and **not** a substantial soul - it is a **logical/formal function**, transcendental (a condition of possibility), not transcendent (a knowable thing).

**Against Hume and rational psychology.** Hume found no *impression* of a self because he sought an empirical one; Kant's "I think" is the *form of all thinking*, which cannot appear *in* experience because it is the condition *of* experience. Equally, we cannot infer that it is a **substance** (that would be the Paralogism) - it is a function, not a thing.

**Link to the transcendental exposition of space and time.** The transcendental exposition shows that the a priori intuitions of space and time make synthetic a priori knowledge (geometry, arithmetic) possible. Apperception is what **unifies** the manifold of that pure intuition, synthesising it according to the categories - so the forms of sensibility and the unity of self-consciousness together constitute one objective experience.

**Verdict.** Apperception is the keystone of the Deduction: the space/time manifold is given, but only the unity of the "I think", legislating through the categories, makes it a single, objective, knowable world.

### Solved PYQ 6 - 2022 Q3(a), 20 marks

**Question:** How does Kant construct antinomies to illustrate the illusory tendencies of pure reason? Explain and examine the antinomies presented by Kant.

#### Model solution

**Thesis (directive: explain + examine).** Kant constructs the antinomies to expose reason's natural illusion of seeking the **unconditioned** beyond experience; "examine" requires the **resolution**, not a catalogue.

**Construction.** An antinomy pairs a **thesis** and **antithesis**, each apparently demonstrable, so that reason - applying the categories to the world-as-a-whole - contradicts itself. Kant offers four:

| # | Thesis                                                    | Antithesis                                    |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1 | world has a beginning in time, limit in space             | world infinite in time and space              |
| 2 | composites consist of simple parts                        | nothing simple exists                         |
| 3 | there is freedom (spontaneous causality) besides nature   | everything happens by natural law; no freedom |
| 4 | an absolutely necessary being belongs to/causes the world | no absolutely necessary being exists          |

**The mathematical/dynamical distinction.** 1-2 (**mathematical**) concern the world's magnitude/composition; 3-4 (**dynamical**) concern its causality/existence.

**Resolution (the examined part).** *Mathematical: both sides false* - the world-whole is never a completed object of experience, so calling it finite or infinite is senseless; both err by treating phenomena as a noumenal totality.

*Dynamical: both can be true* in different domains - natural necessity governs phenomena, while freedom (3rd) and a necessary being (4th) are possible for noumena. The 3rd antinomy thereby secures **room for moral freedom** alongside determinism.

**Verdict.** The antinomies are Kant's most dramatic proof that speculative metaphysics is impossible and serve as an **indirect proof** of transcendental idealism. They show not that reason is unreliable but that it must respect its boundaries; Hegel's rival reading - that such contradictions are *productive* - is the strongest objection to flag.

### Solved PYQ 7 - 2023 Q1(a), 10 marks

**Question:** "Precepts without concepts are blind and concepts without precepts are empty." In the light of this statement discuss how Kant reconciles rationalism with empiricism.

#### Model solution

**Printed-wording note.** The paper prints "**Precepts** without concepts are blind and concepts without **precepts** are empty." The accurate Kantian formulation is "**Thoughts without content are empty; intuitions [Anschauungen] without concepts are blind**" (A51/B75). The stem substitutes "precepts" for "intuitions"; quote the printed line as given, then supply the correct original - do not silently correct UPSC.

**Thesis.** The dictum states Kant's synthesis: knowledge requires **both** sensory intuitions (content) and conceptual organisation (form); neither alone suffices. This *is* the reconciliation of rationalism and empiricism.

**Doctrine.** *Concepts without intuitions are empty:* pure reason spinning concepts with no sensory content yields empty metaphysics - the rationalist error. *Intuitions without concepts are blind:* raw sensation unstructured by the understanding is an unintelligible blur - the empiricist limit. Knowledge = intuitions **plus** concepts = experience. Sensibility (space/time) supplies the given; understanding (the categories) supplies the form; the two are welded by the transcendental unity of apperception.

**How this reconciles the schools.** Rationalism was right that necessity requires a priori structure (Kant grants a priori forms and categories) but wrong to think reason alone knows reality. Empiricism was right that content comes from experience (Kant grants that all knowledge *begins* with experience) but wrong that experience yields necessity. Kant keeps each side's truth and locates its error.

**Verdict.** The synthesis is exact and self-limiting: it legitimises synthetic a priori knowledge but only *within* possible experience - concepts applied beyond intuition (to God, soul, world-whole) relapse into "empty" metaphysics.

### Solved PYQ 8 - 2023 Q1(e), 10 marks

**Question:** What are the main arguments offered by Kant to prove that a priori synthetic judgements are possible? Discuss with examples.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Kant argues that synthetic a priori judgements are possible because the mind imposes its own a priori forms on experience; since we supply the forms, the resulting truths are both **informative** (synthetic) and **necessary** (a priori) - but valid only for objects of possible experience.

**The problem restated.** Cross-classify judgements: analytic (predicate contained in subject, trivially true) vs synthetic (predicate adds information), and a priori (necessary) vs a posteriori (from experience). The interesting class is **synthetic a priori** - new information yet necessary - which Hume's Fork declared impossible.

**Arguments with examples.** (1) *Mathematics*: "**7 + 5 = 12**" is not analytic - the concept of 12 is not contained in "7+5"; yet it is necessary. It is possible because number is grounded in the a priori intuition of **time** (and geometry, e.g. "the straight line is the shortest", in the a priori intuition of **space**). (2) *Physics*: "**every event has a cause**" is synthetic (its denial is not self-contradictory) yet necessary - it is an a priori **category** that constitutes objective experience. (3) *General argument (the Copernican Revolution)*: if objects had to conform to a mind-independent world, necessity would be inexplicable; but if objects of experience conform to the mind's forms (space, time, categories), then those forms are necessarily valid for all such objects.

**Verdict / limit.** Synthetic a priori judgements are possible, legitimising mathematics and the principles of physics - but strictly **within the bounds of possible experience**. Applied beyond (to noumena), the same forms yield only illusion.

### Solved PYQ 9 - 2024 Q1(b), 10 marks

**Question:** How does Kant respond to Hume's scepticism with regard to a priori judgments? Discuss.

#### Model solution

**Thesis.** Kant responds to Hume's scepticism about a priori (causal) judgments not by finding an impression of necessity - he concedes there is none - but by making the necessity an a priori **contribution of the mind**, a category that is a condition of objective experience.

**Hume's challenge.** By the Copy Principle, every idea needs a source impression; inspecting causation we find only priority, contiguity and **constant conjunction**, never a *power* or necessary tie. So the idea of necessary connexion is projected by **custom/habit**, and "every event has a cause" cannot be rationally justified - it is neither analytic nor derivable from experience. This threatens the necessity of science.

**Kant's response.** Awakened "from dogmatic slumber", Kant agrees no *impression* of necessity exists but denies Hume's conclusion. Causality is a **pure concept of the understanding** (a category); "every event has a cause" is **synthetic a priori** - a condition without which an objective, temporally ordered experience is impossible. The substantive proof is the **Second Analogy**: since *time itself cannot be perceived*, the difference between a subjective succession (scanning a house, reversible) and an objective event (a ship drifting, irreversible) can only be fixed by a **rule** - the causal rule.

**Objection / verdict.** Kant meets Hume at the level of **entitlement** to the *concept* of cause, not knowledge of *particular* laws (which stay empirical); **Strawson** objects that order-necessity is not causal necessitation. Still, Kant preserves science's lawfulness by relocating necessity from habit to the a priori form of experience - at the cost that it holds only for **phenomena**, not things-in-themselves.



## Solved PYQ 10 - 2024 Q2(c), 15 marks

**Question:** Critically examine Kant's objections against the ontological argument for the existence of God.

### Model solution

**Thesis (directive: critically examine).** Kant's central objection - "**existence is not a real predicate**" - is decisive against the classical ontological argument; but a full assessment must weigh the modal reformulations it does not obviously touch.

**The argument targeted.** Ontological proofs (Anselm/Descartes) define God as the most perfect / greatest conceivable being and treat **existence** as a perfection contained in that concept, inferring that God must exist.

**Kant's objections.** (1) *Existence adds no content*: a real predicate determines a concept; "being" merely **posits** the object (A598/B626). "A hundred real thalers contain no more than a hundred possible thalers" - the concept is unchanged by actuality, so existence cannot be one of the perfections packed into "God". (2) *No concept entails its object's existence*: from the analysis of any concept, however rich, only more concept follows, never actual existence. (3) *Systemic*: the cosmological and physico-theological proofs covertly rely on this same ontological step (identifying the necessary/designing being with the most-perfect being), so refuting it topples all three.

**Critical assessment.** The classical argument is widely held to be destroyed. However, **modal** versions (Malcolm, Plantinga) argue that *necessary existence* - not bare existence - is the predicate at stake, and that a being whose non-existence is impossible cannot be merely possible; these are not obviously answered by the thalers point. So "critically examine" should concede the objection's success against Descartes/Anselm while noting the modal reopening.

**Verdict.** Against the formulation Kant attacked, the objection is conclusive; existence is not a determining predicate and no being can be defined into actuality. Kant's deeper achievement is to move God from an object of theoretical proof to a **postulate of practical reason** - "deny knowledge to make room for faith" (Bxxx) - theoretical agnosticism, not atheism.

## ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 36 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-28 are core coverage across all ten subtopics; Questions 29-36 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D nine times.

### MCQ 1

Which class of judgement does Kant identify as the central problem of the first Critique?

A. Synthetic a priori - informative yet necessary B. Analytic a priori - necessary but uninformative C. Synthetic a posteriori - informative but contingent D. Analytic a posteriori - contingent and uninformative

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Only synthetic a priori judgements are both informative and necessary; explaining how they are possible is the task of the whole Critique.

### MCQ 2

Kant's 'Copernican Revolution' in philosophy is the claim that:

A. the mind passively mirrors mind-independent objects B. objects of experience conform to the mind's a priori forms C. the earth revolves round the sun, which proves empiricism D. all knowledge is innate and independent of the senses

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Kant reverses the direction of fit: objects conform to the knower's forms (space, time, categories), which is why a priori knowledge of them is possible.

### MCQ 3

Which statement best captures Hume's role in Kant's development?

- A. Hume proved that the categories are exactly twelve
- B. Hume defended the ontological argument Kant later adopted
- C. Hume's problem 'awoke' Kant 'from dogmatic slumber'
- D. Hume showed that space and time are things-in-themselves

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Hume's demonstration that experience yields no necessity forced Kant's critical turn.

### MCQ 4

In Kant, the term 'transcendental' properly refers to:

- A. objects lying wholly beyond all possible experience
- B. God, freedom and immortality as proven realities
- C. a mystical intuition of the thing-in-itself
- D. the a priori conditions of the possibility of experience

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** 'Transcendental' concerns the a priori conditions of experience (legitimate); 'transcendent' means beyond all experience (illegitimate).

### MCQ 5

For Kant, space is:

- A. the a priori form of outer sense
- B. the a priori form of inner sense
- C. an empirical concept abstracted from objects
- D. a property of things-in-themselves

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Space is the pure form of outer intuition; time is the form of inner sense.

### MCQ 6

Time, in the Transcendental Aesthetic, is the a priori form of:

- A. outer sense only
- B. inner sense, and therefore of all representations
- C. things-in-themselves
- D. geometry alone

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Every representation, even an inner one, is in time; time is the form of inner sense and so of all sense.

### MCQ 7

The transcendental exposition of space is meant to explain the possibility of:

- A. arithmetic
- B. empirical psychology
- C. geometry as synthetic a priori knowledge
- D. the ontological argument

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** The a priori intuition of space grounds geometry; the a priori intuition of time grounds arithmetic and pure mechanics.

### MCQ 8

'Transcendentally ideal but empirically real' describes Kant's view that space and time are:

- A. real properties of noumena, merely unknown to us
- B. mere illusions with no objective validity
- C. Newtonian absolute containers
- D. mind-supplied forms, yet objectively valid for all appearances

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Both halves must be held: not features of things-in-themselves, yet objectively valid for every phenomenon.



### MCQ 9

Kant's table of categories is organised under four headings:

A. Quantity, Quality, Relation, Modality B. Space, Time, Substance, Cause C. Soul, World, God, Freedom D. Sensibility, Understanding, Reason, Judgement

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Twelve categories fall into four triads: Quantity, Quality, Relation, Modality.

### MCQ 10

Which category is Kant's direct reply to Hume's scepticism about necessary connexion?

A. Totality (under Quantity) B. Causality (under Relation) C. Limitation (under Quality) D. Possibility (under Modality)

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Causality is an a priori category, which makes 'every event has a cause' a synthetic a priori principle.

### MCQ 11

The 'transcendental unity of apperception' is:

A. an empirical impression of the self, as in Hume B. a substantial, immortal soul proven by reason C. the formal 'I think' that must accompany all my representations D. the highest of the twelve categories

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** It is a logical/formal condition of unified experience, not a substance and not an observed inner object.

### MCQ 12

The metaphysical deduction, as distinct from the transcendental deduction, is the part that:

A. proves God as a postulate of practical reason B. resolves the four antinomies C. justifies applying the categories to experience D. identifies the categories from the forms of judgement

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** The metaphysical deduction identifies the categories; the transcendental deduction justifies their application via apperception.

### MCQ 13

A transcendental schema, for Kant, is essentially:

A. a rule/procedure of time-determination, not an image B. a mental picture resembling both concept and object C. one of the twelve logical forms of judgement D. an empirical concept abstracted from experience

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** The schema is a rule (e.g., for constructing a triangle in general); an image is a determinate product.

### MCQ 14

Why is TIME, rather than space, the medium of all schemata?

A. because space is merely empirical B. because time is the form of inner sense, so all representations are in time C. because geometry is more certain than arithmetic D. because time is a thing-in-itself

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Outer objects are in space, but inner states are not; only time contains every representation, so only time can mediate universally.

### MCQ 15

The schema of the categories of Quantity is:

A. degree or intensive magnitude B. permanence of the real in time C. number - the successive addition of homogeneous units D. existence at a determinate time

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Quantity/time-series -> Number; Quality/time-content -> Degree; Relation/time-order; Modality/time-scope.

### MCQ 16

Kant candidly calls the mechanism of schematism:

A. 'the scandal of philosophy' B. 'a metaphysical article of faith' C. 'the highest principle of all synthetic judgements' D. 'an art concealed in the depths of the human soul'

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** A141/B180-1 - conceding that the productive imagination's procedure is postulated, not exhibited.

### MCQ 17

The First Analogy of Experience establishes:

A. the permanence of substance through all change B. the reciprocity of simultaneous substances C. that every event has a cause D. the existence of a necessary being

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Substance persists (its quantum conserved) as the proxy for time's duration, since time itself cannot be perceived.

### MCQ 18

In the Second Analogy, the irreversibility of my perceptions of a ship drifting downstream shows that:

A. the succession is merely subjective, as with viewing a house B. the objective succession (an event) presupposes a causal rule C. time itself is directly perceived D. substance is not conserved

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Because time cannot be perceived, an irreversible objective order can only be fixed by the rule of cause.

### MCQ 19

The Third Analogy grounds our knowledge of which mode of time through mutual causal community (reciprocity)?

A. duration B. succession C. simultaneity D. necessity

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Simultaneous substances stand in thoroughgoing reciprocal determination (commercium).

### MCQ 20

The single premise driving all three Analogies of Experience is that:

A. every idea is a copy of an impression B. existence is not a real predicate C. the world has no beginning in time D. time itself cannot be perceived

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Since time is not itself perceived, every objective time-relation must be fixed by a rule found in appearances.

### MCQ 21

Kant's Refutation of Idealism (added in the 1787 B-edition) argues that:

A. consciousness of my determinate existence in time proves objects outside me B. only the 'I think' is indubitable and the world is inferred C. matter is impossible and space illusory D. God's existence can be theoretically demonstrated

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Inner time-determination needs a permanent that cannot itself be inner; hence outer experience conditions inner experience, inverting Descartes.

### MCQ 22

Kant labels Descartes 'problematic idealism' and Berkeley 'dogmatic idealism'; he answers Berkeley chiefly by:

A. the Refutation of Idealism proper B. the Transcendental Aesthetic (space as a real a priori form) C. the ontological argument D. the Paralogisms

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Berkeley (matter impossible) is met by the Aesthetic; Descartes (world doubtful) is met by the Refutation proper.

### MCQ 23

On the phenomena/noumena distinction, noumena are:

A. knowable objects of natural science B. identical with Plato's Forms, known by reason C. thinkable but not knowable D. mere illusions with no role in the system

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** We can form the concept (a limiting concept) but cannot know things-in-themselves; phenomena alone are knowable.

### MCQ 24

The 'noumenon in the negative sense' functions as:

A. the efficient cause of our sensations B. a proven immaterial substance C. an object of intellectual intuition D. a limiting concept marking the boundary of sensible knowledge

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** It marks where sensible cognition stops; treating it as a 'cause behind appearances' is Jacobi's objection, not Kant's own doctrine.

### MCQ 25

The three transcendental Ideas of Reason are:

A. Soul, World, God B. Space, Time, Causality C. Thesis, Antithesis, Synthesis D. Sensibility, Understanding, Reason

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Reason seeks the unconditioned totality of inner conditions (Soul), outer conditions (World) and all conditions (God).

### MCQ 26

For Kant the Ideas of Reason are legitimately used when treated as:

- A. constitutive knowledge of real objects
- B. regulative heuristics guiding enquiry toward systematic unity
- C. empirical hypotheses tested by observation
- D. analytic truths of logic

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Regulative ('as if') use is legitimate; taking the Ideas constitutively yields the paralogisms, antinomies and failed God-proofs.

### MCQ 27

The Paralogisms of Pure Reason expose the error of inferring that:

- A. the world has a beginning in time
- B. God exists as the ens realissimum
- C. the 'I think' is a substance / simple soul
- D. space is transcendently real

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** Rational psychology equivocates the formal unity of apperception into a knowable soul-substance.

### MCQ 28

Kant divides the four antinomies into:

- A. thesis and antithesis of equal truth
- B. spatial and temporal
- C. regulative and constitutive
- D. mathematical (1-2) and dynamical (3-4)

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Mathematical antinomies concern magnitude/composition; dynamical antinomies concern causality/existence, and they are resolved differently.

### Remedial MCQ 29

REMEDIAL - A common error is to say 'Kant proves God does not exist.' The accurate position is that Kant:

- A. denies that God's existence can be theoretically proved, then postulates God via practical reason
- B. demonstrates atheism from the antinomies
- C. accepts the ontological argument for God
- D. proves God's existence from the order of nature

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Kant is theoretically agnostic about proof and reinstates God as a moral postulate - not atheism.

### Remedial MCQ 30

REMEDIAL - 'A hundred real thalers contain no more than a hundred possible thalers' illustrates the thesis that:

- A. the cosmological proof is independent of the ontological
- B. existence is not a real (content-adding) predicate
- C. the design argument proves a creator
- D. God is a category of the understanding

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** Existence merely posits the object; it does not enlarge the concept, so it cannot be packed into 'God' as a perfection.

### Remedial MCQ 31

REMEDIAL - Kant resolves the antinomies by holding that:

A. all four have true theses and false antitheses B. all four are genuine contradictions within reason itself C. the mathematical are both false, the dynamical both possibly true D. the mathematical are both true, the dynamical both false

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** The world-whole is no object of experience (mathematical: both false); the phenomena/noumena split reconciles the dynamical (both may be true).

### Remedial MCQ 32

REMEDIAL - Kant argues the cosmological and physico-theological proofs ultimately fail because they:

A. rely on empirical reports of miracles B. confuse analytic with synthetic judgements C. presuppose Hume's theory of causation D. covertly depend on the ontological argument

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Identifying the necessary/designing being with the most-perfect being smuggles in the ontological step, so one refutation sinks all three proofs.

### Remedial MCQ 33

REMEDIAL - Kant's transcendental idealism differs from Berkeley's subjective idealism in that Kant:

A. affirms the empirical reality of external objects, denying only their transcendental reality B. denies the existence of external objects altogether C. holds that objects are ideas in the divine mind D. rejects the a priori forms of intuition

**Correct answer: A**

**Explanation:** Kant is an empirical realist about phenomena; Berkeley dissolves matter into ideas. Kant's idealism concerns the FORM of experience.

### Remedial MCQ 34

REMEDIAL - 'Understanding makes Nature' should be read as the claim that the understanding:

A. literally creates physical objects out of nothing B. legislates the lawful, objective form of phenomenal nature via the categories C. proves the existence of things-in-themselves D. abstracts general laws by induction from repeated observation

**Correct answer: B**

**Explanation:** It is the transcendental constitution of nature's lawful form, not the empirical creation of objects, and not mere induction.

### Remedial MCQ 35

REMEDIAL - The 2023 paper prints 'Precepts without concepts are blind...'. Kant's accurate formulation is:

A. 'Concepts without percepts are transcendent' B. 'Impressions without ideas are empty' C. 'Thoughts without content are empty; intuitions without concepts are blind' (A51/B75) D. 'Existence is not a real predicate'

**Correct answer: C**

**Explanation:** The printed stem substitutes 'precepts' for 'intuitions'; the correct dictum expresses the synthesis of concepts and intuitions.

## Remedial MCQ 36

REMEDIAL - Kant's resolution of the Third Antinomy secures:

A. that the world has a first cause in time B. that everything without exception is naturally determined C. that freedom is empirically observable D. freedom for the noumenal agent alongside natural determinism for phenomena

**Correct answer: D**

**Explanation:** Natural necessity holds for appearances, while freedom (spontaneous causality) is possible for the same agent considered as noumenon.

## ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

### Original Mains 1 - 10 marks

**Question:** Explain Kant's distinction between the *transcendental* and the *transcendent*, and show why conflating them is a cardinal error in reading the first Critique. (Answer in 150 words.)

#### Model solution

**Transcendental** names an enquiry into the a priori **conditions of the possibility of experience** - space, time and the categories, which are in the mind yet valid for all objects of experience. *Transcendent* names what lies **beyond all possible experience** - the soul, the world-whole and God taken as knowable objects. The transcendental is legitimate and knowledge-yielding; the transcendent is precisely where reason overreaches and generates paralogisms, antinomies and failed proofs.

Conflating them is fatal because it converts space/time and the categories from *conditions of appearances* into *properties of things-in-themselves*, reviving the dogmatic metaphysics Kant set out to bound. It also misreads noumena as knowable transcendent objects rather than as a **limiting concept**. Thus the whole critical achievement - securing science while curbing speculation - depends on holding the two apart. **Verdict:** the distinction is the hinge of transcendental idealism, not mere terminology.

### Original Mains 2 - 15 marks

**Question:** Examine Kant's doctrine of the Schematism as the bridge between sensibility and understanding. Why must the mediating schema be a determination of time, and why does Kant concede it is 'an art concealed in the depths of the human soul'? (Answer in 250 words.)

#### Model solution

**Problem (heterogeneity).** Pure categories are intellectual and non-sensible; intuitions are sensible and particular. How can a category (e.g., *substance*) apply to an intuition it in no way resembles? Kant needs a **third thing** homogeneous with both.

**Solution (the schema).** The transcendental schema is a **rule of the productive imagination** - not an image but a procedure. It is *intellectual* in being a rule and *sensible* in being a **time-determination**, so it shares something with category and intuition alike.

**Why time.** Time is the form of **inner sense**, hence of *all* representations (outer objects are in space, but every representation is in time). Only time is universal enough to mediate every category. Kant supplies four time-architectures: **time-series** -> Quantity (schema: *number*); **time-content** -> Quality (schema: *degree/intensive magnitude*); **time-order** -> Relation (schemata: *permanence, succession by rule, coexistence*); **time-scope** -> Modality (*existence at some/a determinate/all time*).

**The concession.** Because the imagination's synthesis operates beneath awareness, Kant calls schematism "an art concealed in the depths of the human soul" (A141/B180-1) - candidly admitting the mechanism is *postulated as necessary*, not exhibited.



**Objection / reply.** Critics (Prichard, later Heidegger) charge that a supposed bridge that is itself hidden explains little. Reply: schematism is a **transcendental necessity** argued regressively - without it categories would be empty - even if its inner working is opaque. **Verdict:** indispensable in role, confessedly obscure in mechanism.

### Original Mains 3 - 20 marks

**Question:** Kant claims to have effected a 'Copernican Revolution' that simultaneously answers Hume and sets the limits of metaphysics. Critically evaluate how the synthetic a priori, the categories and the phenomena/noumena distinction jointly accomplish this, and assess the principal objections. (Answer in 250 words.)

#### Model solution

**The revolution.** Instead of the mind conforming to objects, **objects of experience conform to the mind's forms** (space, time, categories). If the knower supplies the form, that form is necessarily valid for everything experienced - which is exactly how **synthetic a priori** knowledge (mathematics, "every event has a cause") becomes possible.

**Answer to Hume.** Hume rightly found no *impression* of necessity, concluding causation is habit. Kant concedes the point about impressions but relocates necessity: causality is a **category**, a condition of objective time-order, proved in the **Second Analogy** (because time is not perceived, an irreversible objective succession requires a causal rule). Necessity is thus a priori and mind-contributed, not read off the world.

**Limiting metaphysics.** The same forms are valid **only within possible experience**. Applied to the unconditioned (soul, world, God) they yield **paralogisms, antinomies and fallacious proofs**. The **phenomena/noumena** distinction seals this: we know appearances, we can only *think* things-in-themselves. Metaphysics survives as a critique of reason, not as knowledge of the supersensible; God returns as a **practical postulate**.

**Objections.** (1) The **affection problem** (Jacobi): applying "cause" to unknowable noumena breaches Kant's own rule. (2) Geometry's a priori status leaned on **Euclid**, undermined by non-Euclidean/relativistic space. (3) **Hegel**: an unknowable noumenon is incoherent; thought should have no external limit. **Replies:** noumenon is a *negative limiting concept*; the metaphysical exposition survives the geometry worry; the boundary preserves both science and freedom. **Verdict:** a landmark synthesis - decisive against Humean scepticism and dogmatism alike, though the noumenal residue remains its most contested cost.